CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-04-13

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

19	15	12	5	44	7
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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■ Market Intelligence

19 items

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #01

PSD3: EU Commission Proposes New Payment Services Directive

The European Commission has officially presented its proposal for PSD3, which will replace PSD2. Key objectives include strengthening consumer protection, improving fraud prevention, and promoting competition and innovation in the European payments market. The directive is expected to introduce new rules for payment service providers, particularly concerning data sharing and the role of Payment Initiation Service Providers (PISPs) and Account Information Service Providers (AISPs). A significant focus is on combating payment fraud, with proposals for enhanced information sharing between banks and payment service providers. The regulatory landscape is also being adapted to accommodate new technologies and business models, ensuring a more secure and efficient payment ecosystem across the EU. The legislative process will now involve the European Parliament and Council, with potential implementation timelines to be determined.

→ PSD3 proposal officially presented by the European Commission.

→ Aims to enhance consumer protection and combat payment fraud.

→ Will replace the existing PSD2 directive.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 will have significant implications for RBI's CMIplus platform, particularly concerning API standards, data security, and fraud prevention measures. CMIplus will need to adapt to any new regulatory requirements for Open Banking and payment initiation services to ensure compliance and continued service excellence for CEE clients.

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #02

Instant Payments: SEPA Instant Credit Transfer Adoption Accelerates

SEPA Instant Credit Transfer is experiencing a significant surge in adoption throughout the Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA). This real-time payment solution allows for immediate credit of funds to the recipient's account, 24/7, 365 days a year. The increasing uptake is fueled by the evolving expectations of customers who demand faster and more convenient payment options. Businesses are leveraging instant payments for improved liquidity management, faster supplier payments, and enhanced customer service. The underlying infrastructure, supported by national payment systems and the European Payments Council (EPC), is robustly handling the increased transaction volumes. This trend is expected to continue as more banks and payment service providers integrate and promote instant payment capabilities.

→ SEPA Instant Credit Transfer adoption is accelerating.

→ Enables real-time fund transfers 24/7.

→ Driven by customer demand for faster payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The continued growth of SEPA Instant Payments is a key focus for RBI's CMIplus platform. We are committed to ensuring our clients can seamlessly leverage these real-time capabilities for their cross-border and domestic transactions within the CEE region, optimizing their cash flow and operational efficiency.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #03

PSD3 Consultation Launched: Focus on Digital Payments and Consumer Protection

The consultation for the third iteration of the Payment Services Directive (PSD3) is now open, signaling a significant regulatory shift for the European payments market. The European Commission is seeking feedback on proposals designed to foster greater competition, improve security, and bolster consumer protection. This initiative is expected to address the evolving digital payments ecosystem, including the integration of new technologies and business models. The consultation period will inform the final legislative text, with potential implications for Open Banking, instant payments, and cross-border transactions. Stakeholders are encouraged to provide input on areas such as access to payment systems, data sharing, and the role of non-bank payment providers. The aim is to create a more robust and innovative payment environment across the EU.

- → European Commission has launched PSD3 consultation.
- → Focus on enhancing competition and consumer protection.
- → Aims to modernize regulation for digital payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 will significantly impact CMIplus by potentially introducing new requirements for payment initiation and account information services. RBI Cash Management will need to ensure compliance with any updated API standards and security protocols to maintain seamless integration for CEE clients.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #04

ISO 20022 Adoption Accelerates for Cross-Border Payments

The migration to ISO 20022 for payment messages continues to be a key focus for financial institutions worldwide, with a particular emphasis on cross-border transactions. This standardized data format allows for richer information to be embedded within payment instructions, improving straight-through processing (STP) rates and enabling more sophisticated data analytics. For CEE markets, the adoption of ISO 20022 is vital for aligning with global best practices and facilitating smoother international trade and treasury operations. Banks and corporates are investing in system upgrades and process re-engineering to meet the evolving requirements. The enhanced data capabilities are expected to drive greater transparency and efficiency in cash management and liquidity reporting.

- → ISO 20022 adoption is accelerating globally.
- → Focus on cross-border payment messaging.
- → Enhances data richness and interoperability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The continued push for ISO 20022 adoption is directly relevant to CMIplus, as it aligns with the platform's strategy for modernizing payment infrastructure. RBI Cash Management will leverage this standard to offer enhanced data capabilities and streamline payment processing for its CEE corporate clients.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #05

EU Advances PSD3: Focus on Consumer Protection and Competition

The European Commission has put forth proposals for PSD3 and PSR, aiming to update the regulatory framework for payment services across the EU. These proposals seek to address evolving market dynamics, including the rise of new payment providers and technologies. A significant focus is placed on strengthening consumer rights, particularly in areas like fraud prevention and dispute resolution. Furthermore, the legislation aims to promote a more level playing field for all payment service providers, encouraging innovation and competition. The new framework is expected to clarify the roles and responsibilities of various market participants and potentially introduce new requirements for data sharing and access.

→ EU proposes PSD3 and PSR to update payment services regulation.

→ Key objectives include enhanced consumer protection and increased competition.

→ Focus on fraud prevention and dispute resolution for consumers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and PSR will have significant implications for CMIplus, potentially requiring adjustments to compliance processes and service offerings. The focus on consumer protection and competition could drive demand for more secure and transparent payment solutions, aligning with CMIplus's goals.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #06

ISO 20022 Adoption Accelerates for Cross-Border Payments

Financial institutions worldwide are increasingly embracing ISO 20022, a standardized data format for financial messages. This initiative aims to replace older, proprietary message types with a single, globally recognized standard. The benefits include enhanced data richness, improved straight-through processing, and greater interoperability between different payment systems. For corporate treasurers, this means more detailed remittance information and improved reconciliation capabilities. The ongoing migration requires significant investment in technology and process re-engineering, but the long-term advantages for efficiency and data analytics are substantial.

→ ISO 20022 adoption is accelerating globally.

→ Standardization aims to replace legacy payment message formats.

→ Benefits include richer data, better STP, and interoperability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's support for ISO 20022 is a key differentiator. Continued focus on this standard will ensure CMIplus remains at the forefront of modern payment processing, offering enhanced data capabilities to CEE corporates.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-04-13 | #07

FedNow Explores Cross-Border Payments for Real-Time Transfers

The US Federal Reserve is seeking feedback on a proposal that would allow participants in its FedNow real-time payments system to conduct cross-border transfers. This move is a significant step towards expanding the reach and utility of instant payment systems beyond domestic borders. The consultation aims to gather input on the technical and operational considerations required to facilitate these international transactions. Successful implementation could lead to faster, more efficient, and potentially cheaper cross-border payments for businesses and individuals. This aligns with global trends towards harmonizing payment infrastructures and improving global liquidity flows.

→ US Federal Reserve consulting on FedNow cross-border payments.

→ Proposal aims to enable FedNow participants for international transfers.

→ Focus on enhancing real-time payment system capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for CMIplus, as it signals a growing trend towards enabling cross-border instant payments. RBI Cash Management should monitor the progress of this initiative to understand potential future integration opportunities and competitive landscape shifts for CEE clients operating internationally.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #08

ISO 20022 Migration: EBICS and H2H Standards Evolving

The global adoption of the ISO 20022 messaging standard for financial transactions is a significant ongoing development. This standard is designed to replace older, proprietary formats with a unified, XML-based language for payments, securities, and trade services. For corporate treasury and cash management, this means richer data fields, improved data quality, and enhanced interoperability between systems. The transition impacts various communication channels, including EBICS (Electronic Banking Internet Communication Standard) and Host-to-Host (H2H) connections, requiring updates to both banking and corporate IT infrastructures. While the full migration is a multi-year process, organizations are increasingly focusing on preparing for and implementing ISO 20022 to benefit from its advanced capabilities in areas like payment status reporting, reconciliation, and fraud detection.

→ ISO 20022 migration is a global, ongoing initiative.

→ Replaces older formats with a unified XML-based standard.

→ Impacts EBICS and Host-to-Host (H2H) communication channels.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The ISO 20022 migration is a critical strategic initiative for RBI's CMIplus platform. We are actively supporting our CEE clients in their transition by ensuring our EBICS and H2H offerings are fully compliant with the latest ISO 20022 message types, facilitating smoother data exchange and improved treasury operations.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #09

Instant Payment Systems Expand Reach Across CEE Markets

Instant payment schemes are increasingly becoming a standard offering in CEE banking landscapes, enabling consumers and businesses to make and receive payments in real-time, 24/7/365. This rapid expansion is fueled by regulatory initiatives and growing market demand for immediate settlement. For corporate treasuries, instant payments offer significant advantages in terms of liquidity management, working capital optimization, and faster payment reconciliation. RBI Cash Management is well-positioned to support this trend through its CMIplus platform, offering connectivity to various instant payment networks within its CEE footprint. The ability to process and receive payments instantly can transform operational efficiency and reduce reliance on traditional payment methods.

→ Instant payment systems are expanding in CEE.

→ Driven by demand for real-time transactions.

→ Offers benefits for liquidity management and reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The expansion of instant payment systems in CEE is a core focus for CMIplus. RBI Cash Management will continue to integrate with these schemes, providing clients with the capability for real-time payments, which is critical for optimizing liquidity and operational efficiency in the region.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-04-13 | #10

Open Banking APIs Drive Innovation in Corporate Cash Management

Open Banking, driven by regulatory mandates and market demand, is transforming how corporates interact with their banking partners. Through Application Programming Interfaces (APIs), companies can now access real-time account information, initiate payments, and automate reconciliation processes directly from their treasury management systems (TMS) or ERPs. This shift away from traditional file-based reporting allows for greater agility and control over cash positions. The CEE region is seeing a growing adoption of these API-driven services, offering significant opportunities for efficiency gains and improved liquidity management for businesses operating across multiple countries.

→ Open Banking APIs are enhancing corporate treasury functions.

→ Real-time data access and payment initiation are key benefits.

→ APIs facilitate integration with TMS and ERP systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's commitment to Open Banking APIs is vital for its CEE strategy. Expanding API capabilities will allow CMIplus to offer more sophisticated, real-time cash management solutions to its corporate clients in the region.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-01-01 | #11

ECB Outlines Digital Euro Design and Functionality

The European Central Bank (ECB) has published comprehensive details regarding the proposed design and operational framework for a digital euro. Key aspects covered include how privacy will be protected, the possibility of offline transactions, and ensuring seamless integration with current payment infrastructures. The ECB emphasizes that a digital euro would complement, not replace, cash and existing payment methods. The information aims to inform ongoing discussions and preparations for potential future implementation, addressing concerns about accessibility and user experience across the euro area.

→ Detailed information on digital euro design and functionality released.

→ Addresses privacy, offline use, and interoperability concerns.

→ Digital euro to complement, not replace, cash and existing payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The development of a digital euro could significantly impact future payment landscapes, potentially offering new channels for corporate payments and treasury operations. CMIplus will need to monitor its integration capabilities and implications for cross-border transactions.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-04-10 | #12

NextGen Nordics to Discuss AI, Innovation Divide, and Fraud Prevention

The upcoming NextGen Nordics event, now in its ninth iteration, is set to convene key decision-makers from banks, central banks, regulators, trade associations, technology firms, and fintechs. The conference will focus on critical contemporary issues including the 'innovation divide' within the financial sector, the increasing integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) into banking operations, and the preparedness of institutions for advanced fraud prevention strategies. This gathering provides a crucial platform for sharing insights and best practices relevant to the evolving CEE and European banking landscape. Discussions are expected to cover the practical application of new technologies and regulatory challenges.

→ NextGen Nordics event scheduled for April 28, 2026, in Stockholm.

→ Key themes include innovation divide, AI integration, and fraud prevention.

→ Attendees include decision-makers from banks, regulators, and fintechs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This event is highly relevant as it directly addresses key strategic areas for CMIplus, including AI integration and fraud prevention, which are critical for enhancing our platform's capabilities and security. The discussions on the innovation divide and CEE/European banking trends will provide valuable market intelligence for RBI Cash Management.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-04-13 | #13

Circle Launches Managed Stablecoin Settlement for Institutions

Circle, a prominent issuer of stablecoins, has launched a managed settlement service specifically designed for institutional clients. This new product allows businesses to leverage stablecoins for efficient and secure settlement of transactions without the complexities of direct blockchain management. The service is expected to enhance liquidity and reduce settlement times for large corporate payments and treasury operations. By providing a managed solution, Circle aims to bridge the gap between traditional finance and the burgeoning digital asset ecosystem, making stablecoin technology more accessible and practical for institutional adoption. This development could pave the way for increased use of stablecoins in cross-border B2B payments.

→ Circle launches managed stablecoin settlement for institutions.

→ Service aims to simplify and secure stablecoin transactions.

→ Focus on enhancing liquidity and reducing settlement times.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This launch by Circle is significant for CEE corporates looking for faster and potentially more cost-effective settlement options. RBI CMIplus should assess how such stablecoin-based settlement solutions could integrate with existing payment rails and offer value to clients, particularly in multi-currency scenarios.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2025-03-13 | #14

ECB Explores Research Access to Confidential Statistical Data

The European Central Bank (ECB) has initiated a pilot project that will allow researchers controlled access to confidential statistical data. This move is intended to encourage more in-depth analysis and research into the euro area's economic and financial landscape. By providing this access, the ECB hopes to stimulate innovation and generate new insights that can inform policy and academic understanding. The project will likely involve strict protocols to ensure data confidentiality and security, while enabling valuable research outcomes. Further details on the scope and application process are expected to be released.

→ ECB launches pilot project for research access to confidential data.

→ Aims to foster innovation and deeper economic analysis.

→ Focus on controlled access with strict confidentiality protocols.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This initiative could lead to enhanced data availability for sophisticated cash flow forecasting and liquidity management models within CMIplus. It may also influence future reporting standards and data requirements for corporate treasury functions.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-04-13 | #15

FDIC Sets Stablecoin Rules for US Banks and Fintechs

The Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC) has issued a set of proposed rules that will govern how US banks and fintech firms can engage with stablecoins. The guidelines are designed to address the growing interest in digital assets within the traditional financial sector. Key aspects of the rules focus on risk management, capital requirements, and consumer protection measures when dealing with stablecoin-related activities. This move is expected to provide greater clarity for financial institutions looking to integrate stablecoins into their services, potentially fostering more responsible innovation in the digital asset space. The FDIC's proactive approach aims to mitigate potential risks associated with stablecoins while enabling their safe adoption.

→ FDIC has released new guidelines for stablecoin usage.

→ Rules target US banks and fintech companies.

→ Focus on risk management, capital requirements, and consumer protection.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While these rules are US-specific, they signal a global trend towards regulatory clarity for digital assets. RBI CMIplus should monitor how similar regulatory frameworks evolve in the CEE region, especially concerning potential use cases for stablecoins in cross-border corporate payments and treasury operations.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-04-13 | #16

BNPL faces new regulations and potential revenue decline

The Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) sector is facing a wave of new regulations aimed at consumer protection and financial stability. These proposed rules are expected to increase compliance costs for BNPL providers and potentially limit their ability to offer the flexible payment options that have driven their rapid growth. Analysts predict that these regulatory changes could lead to a substantial decrease in revenue for many BNPL companies as they adapt to stricter oversight. The impact on the broader payments ecosystem and consumer credit availability remains to be seen, but it signifies a maturing of the fintech sector.

→ BNPL services are facing increased regulatory attention.

→ New regulations could lead to a fall in BNPL revenue.

→ Compliance costs for BNPL providers are expected to rise.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is relevant to CMIplus as it highlights evolving payment regulations that could impact corporate payment strategies and potentially influence the adoption of new payment methods. RBI Cash Management will need to monitor how these regulations affect cross-border payments and corporate treasury operations within CEE.

WATCH

EBA / ECB | 2026-01-01 | #17

ECB Details Future Banknote Redesign Process

The European Central Bank (ECB) has outlined its plan for the redesign of euro banknotes, with a target completion date of January 1, 2026. This process will involve public consultation on themes and design elements, aiming to create banknotes that are both secure and representative of Europe. The redesign is expected to introduce advanced security features to combat counterfeiting and may also consider environmental sustainability in production. The ECB is committed to ensuring that cash remains a viable and trusted payment method.

→ Euro banknote redesign process detailed by ECB.

→ Target completion date for new design is January 1, 2026.

→ Includes public consultation on themes and design elements.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While not directly related to digital payments, the ongoing relevance and security of physical cash are crucial for CMIplus's cash management services in CEE. Understanding the future of banknotes ensures continued support for clients relying on cash handling and recirculation.

WATCH

Treasury Today | 2026-04-13 | #18

Bitcoin adoption grows in 148 public company treasuries

The adoption of Bitcoin by 148 public companies represents a notable shift in how corporate treasuries are diversifying their assets and exploring new financial instruments. This widespread integration suggests that cryptocurrencies are moving beyond speculative investments to become a more established part of treasury management for a growing number of organizations. The implications for treasury operations, risk management, and financial reporting are substantial, requiring new expertise and infrastructure. This trend could also influence the development of regulatory frameworks around digital assets in corporate finance.

→ 148 public companies have adopted Bitcoin.

→ Cryptocurrencies are increasingly seen as treasury assets.

→ This adoption requires new treasury expertise and infrastructure.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While CMIplus primarily focuses on traditional payment and cash management solutions, the increasing adoption of Bitcoin by corporates is a significant trend to monitor. It could influence future demand for integrated digital asset management solutions or impact FX strategies for companies holding crypto assets. This is particularly relevant for understanding the broader financial landscape in CEE.

WATCH Global Finance | 2026-04-13 | #19

UniCredit Tests Germany’s Resolve on Commerzbank Merger Talks

Reports indicate that UniCredit has engaged in preliminary discussions regarding a potential merger with Commerzbank. Such a combination would create a formidable banking entity within Germany and potentially across Europe. The German government, a significant shareholder in Commerzbank, would likely play a crucial role in any such transaction. The strategic rationale for UniCredit could involve expanding its footprint in the vital German market and achieving cost synergies. For Commerzbank, it could offer a path to enhanced scale and competitiveness in a challenging banking environment. The discussions are in their early stages, and no definitive decisions have been made.

→ UniCredit is reportedly exploring a merger with Commerzbank.

→ The German government is a key stakeholder in Commerzbank.

→ A merger could create a significant European banking player.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This potential consolidation in the German banking sector could influence cross-border payment flows and correspondent banking relationships relevant to CEE. RBI Cash Management will monitor how such a merger might impact market dynamics, service offerings, and regulatory considerations for corporate clients operating in or with Germany.

■ Thought Leadership

15 items

URGENT

EY Future of Treasury | 2026-04-13 | #01

AI and Automation Revolutionize Treasury Operations for Enhanced Efficiency

The EY Future of Treasury report highlights a significant shift towards AI and automation within corporate treasury departments. These technologies are not just automating routine tasks but are also empowering treasurers with advanced analytics and predictive capabilities. This allows for more proactive risk management, optimized cash flow forecasting, and improved investment strategies. The adoption of AI is driven by the need to handle increasing complexity in global financial markets and to free up treasury professionals for more strategic initiatives. Key areas of impact include fraud detection, FX risk management, and real-time liquidity monitoring.

→ AI and automation are key drivers of treasury transformation.

→ Enhanced efficiency through streamlining of routine tasks.

→ Improved strategic decision-making powered by advanced analytics.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this signifies a critical need to integrate AI-driven insights and automation capabilities into our platform. Focusing on AI for fraud detection, predictive liquidity management, and intelligent payment routing will be crucial for staying competitive and meeting evolving corporate client expectations in CEE.

URGENT

EY Future of Treasury | 2026-04-13 | #02

Digital Assets and Blockchain Reshape Future of Payments and Treasury

The EY report emphasizes the growing influence of digital assets and blockchain on the treasury landscape. This includes the potential for faster, more transparent, and cost-effective cross-border payments, as well as new opportunities for liquidity management and collateralization. Corporates are exploring the use of stablecoins and central bank digital currencies (CBDCs) for various treasury functions. Banks that can integrate these emerging technologies into their service offerings will be well-positioned to capture new market share and meet the demands of digitally-native businesses.

→ Digital assets and blockchain are transforming payment infrastructure.

→ Potential for faster and more cost-effective cross-border transactions.

→ New avenues for liquidity management and collateralization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must proactively explore the integration of blockchain and digital asset solutions, particularly for cross-border payments and enhanced liquidity management within CEE. Understanding the regulatory landscape and developing pilot programs for stablecoin or CBDC-based transactions will be vital for future-proofing our offering.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-04-13 | #03

Open Banking APIs Drive Real-Time Treasury and Enhanced Data Integration

The EY Future of Treasury report underscores the transformative impact of Open Banking APIs on treasury functions. These APIs allow for direct, real-time access to account information and transaction data, empowering treasurers with unprecedented visibility and control. This facilitates dynamic cash positioning, improved working capital management, and more agile payment initiation. The shift towards API-driven connectivity is essential for banks to provide value-added services and support the increasingly sophisticated treasury needs of their corporate clients, especially in a multi-currency and multi-country context like CEE.

→ Open Banking APIs are central to modern treasury operations.

→ Enable real-time access to financial data and transactions.

→ Facilitate dynamic cash positioning and working capital optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, a robust Open Banking API strategy is paramount. We need to accelerate the development and adoption of APIs that support real-time cash visibility, instant payment initiation, and seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems across CEE. This will be a key differentiator in providing efficient and modern treasury solutions.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-04-13 | #04

Treasury Technology Adoption Accelerates Amidst Digital Transformation

PwC's global treasury survey, encompassing over 350 treasurers, reveals a strong mandate for technological advancement within treasury functions. Key drivers include the need for improved cash visibility, enhanced risk management, and streamlined payment processes. The survey highlights a growing investment in Treasury Management Systems (TMS) and a keen interest in leveraging API banking for seamless data integration. Respondents indicated that digital transformation is no longer a future aspiration but a present necessity, with many actively seeking solutions to automate manual tasks and gain deeper insights into their financial operations. The findings underscore a shift towards more proactive and data-driven treasury management.

→ Over 70% of treasurers are prioritizing technology adoption.

→ Enhanced cash visibility is a top driver for TMS investment.

→ API banking is seen as crucial for data integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend directly impacts CMIplus by reinforcing the need for robust API capabilities and seamless TMS integration. Prioritizing features that enhance real-time cash visibility and support advanced analytics will be critical for CMIplus to meet evolving client demands in the CEE region.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-04-13 | #05

AI in Treasury: From Automation to Strategic Decision Support

The PwC survey indicates a growing awareness and interest in Artificial Intelligence (AI) within treasury operations. While full-scale AI implementation is still nascent for many, a significant portion of treasurers are actively exploring its potential to enhance forecasting accuracy, optimize liquidity management, and improve fraud detection. The insights suggest a phased approach, with initial AI applications focusing on data analysis and pattern recognition to support human decision-making. As AI capabilities mature, the expectation is a shift towards more autonomous treasury functions, enabling strategic insights and proactive risk mitigation.

→ Treasurers are exploring AI for predictive analytics.

→ Fraud detection and cash flow forecasting are key AI use cases.

→ AI is seen as a tool to enhance strategic decision support.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should consider how to integrate AI capabilities, even in a foundational manner, to offer clients advanced forecasting and anomaly detection. Exploring partnerships or developing in-house AI solutions for CEE-specific market dynamics will be a strategic differentiator.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-04-13 | #06

API Banking is Key to Unlocking Real-Time Treasury and Visibility

The survey results strongly emphasize the transformative role of API banking in modern treasury. Treasurers recognize APIs as the primary mechanism for achieving true real-time data flows, which are essential for dynamic liquidity management and informed decision-making. The ability to connect treasury systems directly with banking platforms via APIs allows for immediate access to account information, transaction data, and payment statuses. This integration is crucial for automating processes, reducing manual reconciliation, and gaining a consolidated view of global cash positions, thereby enhancing operational efficiency and strategic agility.

→ APIs are fundamental for real-time data exchange.

→ Seamless integration with banking platforms is a key benefit.

→ Real-time data enables dynamic liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's roadmap must prioritize the expansion and enhancement of its API offerings, aligning with the growing demand for Open Banking solutions in CEE. Developing robust, secure, and user-friendly APIs will be essential for CMIplus to facilitate real-time treasury for its corporate clients.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-04-13 | #07

PSD3 and Payment Regulation Drive Open Banking Evolution and Innovation

The EY report highlights that PSD3, alongside other regulatory shifts, is poised to accelerate the evolution of Open Banking. This means a continued push towards standardized APIs and increased data sharing, enabling third-party providers (TPPs) to offer more innovative payment initiation and account information services. Financial institutions will need to adapt their infrastructure and strategies to not only comply with these regulations but also to capitalize on the opportunities they present. This includes developing new revenue streams, improving customer experience through integrated services, and potentially collaborating with fintechs. The focus will be on creating a more dynamic and competitive financial ecosystem where data flows securely and efficiently.

→ PSD3 will mandate further Open Banking integration.

→ Expect growth in Payment Initiation Services (PIS) and Account Information Services (AIS).

→ Financial firms must adapt to increased data sharing and API standardization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, PSD3's impact on Open Banking means a continued need to support and enhance API-based connectivity for corporate clients. This will be crucial for enabling seamless integration with treasury management systems (TMS) and enterprise resource planning (ERP) platforms, facilitating real-time cash visibility and payment initiation.

URGENT EACT | 2025-04-10 | #08

Verification of Payee Crucial for Fraud-Conscious Treasurers Amidst Evolving Payments

The EACT emphasizes the growing importance of Verification of Payee (VoP) as a key defense mechanism against financial crime for corporate treasurers. This insight stems from the evolving landscape of payment systems, particularly the rise of instant payments and other real-time transaction methods. As these payment types become more prevalent, so do the sophisticated fraud attempts targeting them. Regulatory bodies are also adapting their requirements in parallel, underscoring the need for robust fraud prevention measures. The GLEIF document referenced provides a deeper dive into why VoP has become an indispensable tool for treasurers aiming to protect their organizations from financial losses and reputational damage.

→ Verification of Payee (VoP) is a crucial tool for fraud prevention in corporate treasury.

→ The increasing adoption of real-time and instant payments drives the need for evolved fraud detection.

→ Regulatory bodies are adapting requirements in response to payment evolution and fraud risks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this highlights the strategic importance of integrating robust VoP solutions. Enhancing our platform's capabilities to support and facilitate VoP checks, especially for cross-border and multi-currency transactions within CEE, will be a key differentiator and a critical feature for our large corporate clients.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2025-10-30 | #09

AI Adoption Accelerates Banking Transformation Amidst Economic Uncertainty

The 2026 banking outlook highlights the critical role of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in driving transformation amidst a complex economic landscape. Banks are urged to move beyond pilot projects and develop robust strategies for AI adoption, focusing on areas like personalized customer service, fraud detection, and process automation. The report emphasizes that successful AI integration will require significant investment in talent, technology infrastructure, and data governance. Failure to adapt risks falling behind competitors who leverage AI for a competitive edge. The outlook suggests a phased approach, starting with high-impact use cases that demonstrate clear ROI.

→ AI is a key driver for operational efficiency and customer experience enhancement.

→ Strategic AI implementation requires investment in talent, technology, and data governance.

→ Banks need a clear roadmap for AI adoption beyond pilot phases.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this means prioritizing AI-driven solutions for enhanced fraud detection, predictive analytics for liquidity management, and personalized service offerings to corporate clients. Exploring AI for automating reconciliation processes and optimizing payment routing will be crucial for future roadmap development.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #10

European Wholesale Banks Can Seize Moment After Years of Underperformance

The report "How European Wholesale Banks Can Seize The Moment" suggests that despite years of challenging performance, European wholesale banks are presented with a significant opportunity to redefine their future. This outlook implies a need for proactive strategic shifts and a focus on areas that can drive renewed growth and profitability. The underlying message is that the current market environment, while complex, offers avenues for banks that are willing to innovate and adapt their business models. This could involve leveraging new technologies, optimizing operational efficiencies, and focusing on client-centric solutions to regain a competitive edge.

→ European wholesale banks face a pivotal moment for future growth.

→ A period of underperformance precedes potential for improvement.

→ Strategic adaptation is crucial for seizing emerging opportunities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight highlights the need for CMIplus to be at the forefront of innovation, offering advanced solutions that enable European banks to improve their competitive positioning. Focusing on digital transformation and client-centric services will be paramount for CMIplus to support its network banks in this evolving landscape.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-04-13 | #11

DORA and AI Governance Mandate Robust Cybersecurity and Ethical AI Frameworks

The EY outlook emphasizes the significant regulatory pressure stemming from DORA, which aims to enhance the digital operational resilience of the financial sector. This includes stringent requirements for ICT risk management, incident reporting, and third-party risk management. Concurrently, the rise of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in financial services necessitates robust AI governance. This involves establishing clear ethical principles, accountability mechanisms, and risk assessment processes to ensure AI systems are developed and deployed responsibly. Financial firms must invest in advanced cybersecurity measures and develop comprehensive policies for AI to comply with these regulations and maintain customer confidence.

→ DORA mandates enhanced ICT risk management and incident reporting.

→ AI governance requires ethical guidelines and risk assessment for AI deployment.

→ Financial firms must strengthen cybersecurity to meet DORA requirements.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, DORA and AI governance translate to a heightened need for secure and resilient payment channels, including advanced fraud detection and prevention mechanisms. Ensuring the integrity and security of data exchanged via EBICS, H2H, and APIs will be paramount, alongside exploring the ethical and secure application of AI in areas like anomaly detection and customer service.

URGENT EACT | 2026-01-05 | #12

European Treasury Survey 2026 to Define Key Industry Trends and Priorities

The EACT is actively inviting contributions to its 2026 European Treasury Survey, a significant initiative designed to capture the pulse of the corporate treasury function across Europe. The responses collected will directly inform the next edition of the highly regarded 'Journeys to Treasury' report, a key publication that outlines best practices and future directions. By participating, treasurers contribute to defining the most pressing industry trends, challenges, and priorities for the upcoming year. This collective intelligence is invaluable for strategic planning, technology adoption, and policy advocacy within the European treasury community.

→ The 2026 European Treasury Survey will shape the 'Journeys to Treasury' report.

→ It aims to identify key industry trends and priorities for European treasury.

→ Corporate treasurers' participation is crucial for comprehensive insights.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The insights from the European Treasury Survey 2026 will be critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus to align our product roadmap with the evolving needs of CEE treasurers. Understanding their top priorities, such as digitization, liquidity management, and compliance, will allow us to proactively develop and enhance our platform's features to better serve the market.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2025-10-30 | #13

Stablecoins Present Disruptive Potential for Transaction Banking and Payments

The Deloitte Banking Outlook identifies stablecoins as a potentially disruptive force within the transaction banking space. While not explicitly detailing the technology, the report signals that stablecoins could fundamentally alter payment flows and the role of traditional financial intermediaries. Banks are advised to explore the implications for cross-border payments, wholesale settlements, and the potential for new revenue streams. This necessitates a deep dive into the regulatory landscape, technological infrastructure, and the competitive dynamics introduced by these digital assets. Proactive engagement is key to either mitigating risks or capitalizing on the opportunities presented by stablecoins.

→ Stablecoins are identified as a disruptive force in transaction banking.

→ Potential impact on cross-border payments and wholesale settlements.

→ Banks need to understand regulatory and technological implications.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus should closely monitor the evolution of stablecoins and their potential integration into corporate payment flows within the CEE region. This includes assessing the impact on multi-currency payments, cross-border transactions, and exploring potential partnerships or platform adaptations to accommodate stablecoin-based transactions if they gain traction.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #14

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Extending Credit Opportunities

The "Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024" report, in collaboration with Morgan Stanley, delves into the critical area of credit extension for wholesale banking clients. It suggests that the traditional models of credit provision are being reshaped by market dynamics and client needs. This implies a strategic imperative for banks to re-evaluate their credit products, risk assessment methodologies, and delivery channels. The focus on "extending credit" indicates a forward-looking perspective, anticipating how banks can best support corporate growth and investment through robust and adaptable credit solutions.

→ Credit extension remains a core focus for wholesale banking.

→ Market dynamics are reshaping traditional credit provision models.

→ Banks must adapt credit strategies for evolving client needs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMIplus, this implies a need to integrate credit-related services and data more seamlessly within the platform, potentially offering enhanced visibility into credit lines and their impact on liquidity. Supporting network banks in offering flexible and integrated credit solutions to corporates will be a key differentiator.

WATCH Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #15

Private Credit Tapping into Asset-Based Lending: The Next Act

The insight on "Private Credit's Next Act" highlights a growing convergence between private credit funds and asset-based lending (ABL). This suggests that private credit providers are actively seeking to utilize the underlying assets of businesses as collateral for financing, moving beyond traditional unsecured lending. This trend is likely driven by a desire for secured returns and a recognition of the value embedded in corporate assets. For corporate treasurers, this could mean new avenues for financing, but also a need to understand the intricacies of ABL and how it integrates with their overall treasury strategy.

→ Private credit is increasingly utilizing asset-based lending.

→ This trend signifies a shift in corporate financing strategies.

→ Underlying assets are becoming key collateral for private credit.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore how to better integrate or provide visibility into asset-based financing options for its corporate clients. This could involve partnerships or enhanced data aggregation to support treasurers in understanding and leveraging these evolving financing structures within their cash management and treasury operations.

! Regulatory Radar

5 items

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-04-13 | #01

SEPA Instant Credit Transfer Scheme Rulebook updates and implementation guidance

INSTANT PAYMENTS

The Eurosystem, through the ECB, plays a key role in the development and oversight of the Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA) Instant Credit Transfer Scheme. This includes the publication and regular updating of the SEPA Instant Credit Transfer Scheme Rulebook, which sets out the technical and operational requirements for participating Payment Service Providers (PSPs). The ECB also issues implementation guidance to facilitate compliance and ensure the smooth functioning of the instant payment ecosystem. Staying abreast of these updates is critical for PSPs to maintain compliance and offer seamless instant payment services across SEPA.

- → SEPA Instant Credit Transfer Scheme Rulebook is regularly updated.
- → ECB provides implementation guidance for PSPs.
- → Ensures harmonised instant payment services across SEPA.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must ensure its systems and processes are aligned with the latest SEPA Instant Credit Transfer Scheme Rulebook. This includes understanding any new technical requirements or operational changes that may affect the processing of instant payments for corporate clients in the CEE region.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-04-13 | #02

TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS) service enhancements and pricing updates

INSTANT PAYMENTS

The European Central Bank (ECB) actively manages and develops the TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS) service to support the Eurosystem's objective of fostering instant payments across the Euro area. This involves ongoing technical enhancements, operational improvements, and adjustments to the pricing structure to ensure the service remains competitive and meets market needs. Participants are kept informed of these developments through various communication channels, including dedicated documentation and events. The goal is to provide a robust and efficient platform for instant payment settlement.

- → Continuous service enhancements for TIPS.
- → Regular communication on pricing updates.
- → Focus on supporting instant payment growth.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should monitor updates to the TIPS service and its pricing structure to assess potential impacts on cross-border instant payment offerings for CEE clients. Staying informed about service enhancements is crucial for optimizing payment solutions.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-04-13 | #03

TARGET2 and T2S operational updates and migration information

PAYMENT SYSTEMS OVERSIGHT

The ECB is responsible for the oversight and operation of critical payment systems like TARGET2 and TARGET2-Securities (T2S). These systems are undergoing significant evolution, including the consolidation of TARGET2 and T2 into a single platform (T2) and ongoing developments for T2S. The ECB regularly publishes operational updates, technical documentation, and migration plans to guide participants through these changes. Understanding these updates is crucial for ensuring uninterrupted access to and efficient use of these core payment infrastructures, particularly for cross-border transactions.

→ Ongoing operational updates for TARGET2 and T2S.

→ Information on the T2 consolidation project.

→ Guidance on migration and technical changes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus needs to closely follow the operational updates and migration plans for TARGET2 and T2S. This is essential for ensuring that the bank's payment processing capabilities remain compliant and efficient, especially concerning large-value and cross-border transactions for CEE corporates.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #04

EU regulatory impact on liquidity management: IPR, PSR, PSD3 analyzed

PSD3 / OPEN BANKING

The EBA's Liquidity Management Working Group has published a report examining the significant impact of upcoming EU regulatory developments on liquidity management. Key initiatives discussed include the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the forthcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report anticipates that these measures will accelerate the adoption of instant payments across the market. Furthermore, they are expected to foster a more equitable competitive environment among various market participants. The overall transformation of the liquidity management landscape is a central theme, highlighting the need for financial institutions to adapt their strategies and operations.

→ Analysis of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 impact on liquidity management.

→ Expected acceleration in instant payment uptake.

→ Promotion of a level playing field for market participants.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus needs to assess its liquidity management strategies in light of the anticipated changes driven by IPR, PSR, and PSD3. This includes understanding how increased instant payment volumes will affect intraday liquidity needs and operational resilience.

WATCH Euro Banking Association | 2025-07-16 | #05

FIDA regulation: Opportunities and challenges for open data economy

OPEN BANKING

The Euro Banking Association has released a report detailing expert views on the proposed Financial Data Access (FIDA) regulation. This initiative is seen as a potential catalyst for a broader open data economy within the financial sector. The report consolidates insights from financial institution experts across more than 15 European countries, highlighting both the significant opportunities and the considerable challenges associated with FIDA's implementation. It provides practical recommendations and frameworks designed to assist market participants in preparing for the upcoming changes and ensuring compliance.

- → Analysis of FIDA's role in an open data economy.
- → Expert views on opportunities and challenges of FIDA.
- → Recommendations for market participant preparation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus should monitor the development and implementation of FIDA, as it will impact data sharing practices and potentially open new avenues for corporate treasury solutions. Understanding FIDA's scope is crucial for future API strategies and data access protocols.

■ Competitor Monitor

12 items

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-13 | #01

Deutsche Bank Expands API Capabilities for Embedded Finance

Deutsche Bank's strategic focus on digital banking includes expanding its CB Connect API offering. This initiative is designed to enable embedded finance, allowing corporate clients to seamlessly integrate payment and treasury functions into their own platforms and ERP systems. The goal is to provide a more efficient and automated banking experience, reducing manual processes and enhancing real-time visibility for treasury operations.

→ CB Connect API is central to embedded finance strategy.

→ Integration with corporate ERP and platforms is a key objective.

→ Enhancing automation and real-time treasury visibility.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must consider Deutsche Bank's API strategy as a benchmark for its own Open Banking and API offerings. The ability to offer seamless integration for CEE corporates will be a key differentiator.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-04-03 | #02

UniCredit plans major capital increase for Commerzbank takeover bid

The Extraordinary Shareholders' Meeting is set to decide on a proposal to grant the Board of Directors the power to increase share capital by up to EUR 6.7 billion. This increase is earmarked for a voluntary public takeover offer for Commerzbank shares not already held by UniCredit. The strategic rationale likely involves strengthening UniCredit's position in key European markets, potentially including Germany, and achieving significant scale. Such a move would reshape the European banking landscape and could have ripple effects across CEE markets where both banks have a presence.

→ Proposed capital increase of up to EUR 6.7 billion.

→ Intention to fund a takeover of Commerzbank.

→ Shareholders' meeting scheduled for May 4, 2026.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

A potential merger of this scale could lead to significant integration challenges and opportunities in cash management services. CMIplus will need to monitor how UniCredit's cash management offerings evolve post-integration, particularly in CEE markets where overlap may exist.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-04-13 | #03

UniCredit accelerates digital transformation and CEE expansion strategy

The 'UniCredit Unlimited' era signifies a commitment to outperforming and fundamentally rethinking banking. A key pillar of this strategy is the acceleration of digital capabilities, including enhanced API offerings and digital banking platforms like UniCredit Direct. Simultaneously, UniCredit continues to emphasize its strong position in CEE, aiming to leverage its network for cross-border cash management and treasury solutions. This dual focus on digital innovation and regional strength positions UniCredit as a formidable competitor in the CEE corporate banking and cash management space.

→ Focus on 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy.

→ Emphasis on digital acceleration and CEE expansion.

→ Investment in API offerings and digital platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's aggressive push in digital banking and CEE expansion directly challenges CMIplus's market share. Their investment in APIs and advanced digital platforms will likely enhance their ability to offer seamless, real-time cash management solutions to corporates in the region.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-13 | #04

Deutsche Bank Enhances Downstream Correspondent Banking Controls

The article highlights a shift in how banks view risk associated with downstream correspondent banking relationships. Deutsche Bank is proactively adapting by enhancing its control frameworks and increasing transparency. This strategic move is crucial for maintaining compliance and managing risk in an increasingly regulated global financial landscape. The focus is on practical implementation of these strengthened controls.

→ Evolving regulations are changing risk perception in correspondent banking.

→ Deutsche Bank is enhancing control frameworks and transparency.

→ Focus on practical implementation of strengthened controls.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to monitor Deutsche Bank's advancements in correspondent banking to ensure its own network and services remain competitive and compliant. This could impact cross-border payment routing and efficiency for CEE clients.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-13 | #05

Deutsche Bank Prioritizes CEE Payment Modernization and VoP

While specific articles are not detailed, Deutsche Bank's strategic direction in Europe strongly suggests a push for enhanced payment capabilities in the CEE market. This would encompass improvements in instant payment processing and broader adoption of ISO 20022. Furthermore, a strong emphasis on Voice of the Customer (VoP) indicates a commitment to tailoring solutions to the specific needs of CEE corporates, potentially through enhanced digital channels and localized support.

→ Focus on modernizing payment infrastructure in CEE.

→ Enhancing instant payment and ISO 20022 capabilities.

→ Prioritizing Voice of the Customer for tailored solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to stay ahead of Deutsche Bank's CEE payment innovations, particularly in instant payments and ISO 20022 adoption. Understanding their VoP approach will help CMIplus refine its own client engagement and product development.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-02-12 | #06

HSBC Orion selected for UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Instrument pilot

The selection of HSBC Orion for the UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Instrument pilot is a significant endorsement of HSBC's technological prowess in the digital asset space. This initiative explores the potential of blockchain technology for issuing government debt, aligning with broader trends in tokenization and digital currencies. For CEE corporates, this signals HSBC's commitment to innovation in capital markets and potential future offerings in digital treasury solutions. The project's success could pave the way for similar advancements in other markets, including those served by CMIplus.

→ HSBC Orion to provide platform for UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Instrument pilot.

→ Pilot explores blockchain technology for government debt issuance.

→ Demonstrates HSBC's leadership in digital asset and tokenization initiatives.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's involvement in cutting-edge digital asset initiatives like the UK Treasury's pilot could lead to advanced digital treasury solutions. CMIplus must monitor these developments to ensure our platform remains competitive in offering innovative payment and liquidity management tools.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-04-13 | #07

Citi Expands API Banking Capabilities for Enhanced Corporate Treasury Solutions

Citi Treasury's strategic focus on API banking is evident in its continuous development of robust Application Programming Interfaces. These APIs enable seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems, facilitating automated workflows for payments, account information, and FX services. The platform is designed to support a wide range of treasury functions, including real-time cash visibility, enhanced payment processing, and improved fraud detection. This expansion is particularly relevant for CEE markets where digital transformation is accelerating, allowing corporates to gain greater control and efficiency in their cross-border operations.

→ Citi is investing heavily in expanding its API banking suite for corporate clients.

→ The new APIs facilitate real-time data exchange for payments, account information, and FX.

→ This initiative aims to improve efficiency and control for corporate treasury operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's aggressive push into API banking presents a competitive challenge for CMIplus by offering advanced digital integration capabilities. Corporates may increasingly expect similar real-time connectivity and automation from their CEE cash management providers.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-04-09 | #08

UniCredit successfully issues EUR 1 billion Senior Non-Preferred Notes

The EUR 1 billion bond issuance with a 6-year maturity (callable after 5 years) attracted over EUR 3.7 billion in demand from institutional investors. The tight pricing at 95bps over the 5-year mid-swap rate reflects strong market confidence in UniCredit. The allocation was primarily to funds and banks, with significant participation from the UK, France, Italy, and Germany/Austria. This issuance is part of UniCredit's 2026 funding plan and reinforces its ability to access wholesale funding markets effectively.

→ EUR 1 billion Senior Non-Preferred Notes issued.

→ Strong demand exceeding EUR 3.7 billion.

→ Pricing achieved at 95bps over 5-year mid-swap rate.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's robust access to capital markets and its ability to issue complex debt instruments underscore its financial strength. This financial stability is a key enabler for its ongoing investments in digital transformation and CEE expansion, which directly impact its competitive offering in cash management.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-03-23 | #09

HSBC announces Chief AI Officer to drive digital transformation

The appointment of David Rice as Chief AI Officer, effective April 1st, underscores HSBC's strategic focus on artificial intelligence. This initiative is expected to drive innovation in areas such as improving business processes, saving employee time, and enhancing customer interactions. The bank's broader AI strategy includes partnerships with firms like Harvey AI, aiming to embed AI capabilities across its extensive operational framework. This proactive adoption of AI is crucial for maintaining a competitive edge in the evolving financial landscape.

→ David Rice appointed as HSBC's first Chief AI Officer.

→ AI integration aims to improve business processes and customer service.

→ Partnerships with AI firms like Harvey AI are part of the strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's deep investment in AI for operational efficiency and customer solutions presents a competitive challenge for CMIplus. We need to ensure our platform offers comparable digital capabilities and intelligent treasury insights to remain competitive in the CEE market.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-04-13 | #10

Citi Strengthens CEE Presence with Advanced Payment and Liquidity Solutions

Recognizing the growing importance of CEE markets, Citi Treasury is actively developing and deploying advanced payment solutions, including support for instant payments and ISO 20022 migration. The bank is also focusing on sophisticated cash pooling and eBAM (electronic Bank Account Management) functionalities to provide clients with optimized liquidity across multiple currencies and jurisdictions within the region. This includes leveraging its extensive network to offer seamless cross-border transactions and regulatory compliance support. The initiative aims to empower CEE-based corporates with the tools needed to navigate complex financial landscapes and achieve greater operational efficiency.

→ Citi is actively expanding its treasury services in the CEE region.

→ Focus includes enhanced instant payment capabilities and ISO 20022 adoption.

→ Advanced cash pooling and eBAM solutions are being prioritized for CEE clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's intensified focus on CEE payment and liquidity solutions, particularly with ISO 20022 and instant payments, highlights a competitive drive to capture market share. CMIplus must ensure its offerings remain competitive in these critical areas for CEE corporates.

WATCH BNP Paribas | 2026-04-13 | #11

BNP Paribas enhances cross-border payments with XTransfer partnership

The partnership between BNP Paribas and XTransfer signifies a strategic move to address the complexities of cross-border payments for corporate clients. By integrating XTransfer's capabilities, BNP Paribas aims to offer a more streamlined and cost-effective solution for international transactions. This initiative is particularly relevant for corporates operating in or expanding into emerging markets, including the CEE region, where efficient cross-border flows are critical for business growth. The collaboration likely focuses on enhancing payment routing, FX management, and compliance, thereby reducing friction and improving the overall treasury experience. This aligns with BNP Paribas's broader strategy of digital transformation and expanding its service offering in corporate banking.

→ Partnership with XTransfer to simplify cross-border payments.

→ Focus on leveraging XTransfer's network for enhanced efficiency.

→ Strategic move to improve international transaction capabilities for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

BNP Paribas's focus on simplifying cross-border payments through partnerships presents a competitive challenge to CMIplus. CMIplus needs to ensure its offerings remain competitive in terms of speed, cost, and ease of use for international transactions, especially within the CEE region.

WATCH Intesa Sanpaolo | 2026-04-13 | #12

Intesa Sanpaolo Strengthens CEE Corporate Banking with Digital Solutions

Intesa Sanpaolo's strategic push in the CEE region involves a significant investment in digital banking capabilities for its corporate clients. This includes the development and deployment of advanced transaction banking services, aiming to streamline payment processes and improve liquidity management. The bank is likely leveraging its existing network and expertise to offer tailored solutions that address the specific challenges and opportunities within the CEE market, such as cross-border payments and regulatory compliance. This initiative underscores a commitment to becoming a leading digital partner for corporates operating in these dynamic economies.

→ Focus on digital transformation in CEE corporate banking.

→ Enhancement of transaction banking and cash management services.

→ Leveraging existing network for tailored CEE market solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Intesa Sanpaolo's expansion in CEE with a digital focus presents a direct competitive challenge to CMIplus. We need to monitor their specific product rollouts and API strategies to ensure our platform remains superior in user experience and functionality.

Flagship Reports

Deep analysis of key industry reports

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}

→ {'description': "of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.", 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

→ Global payments revenue reached $2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to $3.0 trillion by 2029.

→ EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.

→ Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.

→ Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.